22.8.2 Hepatitis -B or Serum Hepatitis

It occurs due to infection of **hepatitis-B virus** (HBV). The virus damages the liver cells causing **acute inflammation** and **cirrhosis** of liver.

It is transferred from infected mother to their babies or by sexual contact. It is also transmitted by contact with infected person's secretions such as saliva, sweat, tears, breast milk and blood.

Symptoms observed are fever, loss of appetite, nausea vomiting, yellowness of eyes and skin, light coloured stools, itching of skin, headache and joint pain.

Prevention and Control

- Screening of blood donors before blood donation can prevent the transmission.
- Injection of drugs to be prevented.
- Having safe and protected sex.
- Sharing of razors should be avoided.
- The hepatitis B vaccine offers excellent protection against HBV. The vaccine is safe and highly effective.

Some of the other sexually transmitted diseases caused by bacteria and virus are discussed in Table 22.7.

22.9 Immunization

Immunization is a process of developing resistance to infections by administration of antigens or antibodies. Inoculation of vaccines into the body to prevent diseases is called as vaccination.

One effective way of controlling the spread of infection is to strengthen the host defenses. This is accomplished by immunization, which is one of the cost effective weapon of modern medicine.

When a large proportion of a community is immunized against a disease, the rest of the people in the community are benefited because the disease does not spread.

22.9.1 Vaccines and its Types

Vaccines are preparation of living or killed microorganisms or their products used for prevention or treatment of diseases. Vaccines are of two types: Live vaccines and Killed vaccines

Live Vaccines: They are prepared from living organisms. The pathogen is weakened and administered. e.g. BCG vaccine, oral polio vaccine.

Table 22.7 Sexually transmitted diseases

Infectious agent	Disease	Causative Organism	Mode of Transmission	Tissue/ Organ Affected	Symptoms
Bacteria	Gonorrhoea	*Neisseria gonorrhoea*	Sexual contact	Urethra is affected	Discharge from genital openings, pain during urination
	Syphilis	*Treponema pallidum*	Sexual contact	Minute abrasion on the skin or mucosa, of genital area	Ulceration on genitals, skin eruption
Virus	Genital Herpes	*Herpes Simplex Virus*	Sexual contact, entry through mucous membrane of genital region	Genital organs of male and female individuals	Painful blisters in mouth, lips, face and genital region
	Genital Warts	*Human Papilloma virus*	Sexual contact (skin to skin)	Genital areas of male and female individuals	Vaginal discharge, itching, bleeding and burning

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